



# Design

Any product has to be well designed to succeed. Excellent designs for everyday items—from the Anglepoise lamp to reflective road signs—have shaped our modern world.

## How it works

The starting point for design is an idea for a product that fulfills a need, whether it is a specialty item or something in day-to-day use. The designer has to think of ways in which a product can serve its purpose and meet other criteria, including aesthetics, cost, durability, and environmental considerations. The design may be integral to the product, such as Apple's rectangular devices with rounded corners, for which it obtained a design patent. Some designs are iconic, such as the Coca-Cola bottle. Yet design is more than just shape. As well as functionality, it includes materials and color, and extends from the products to their packaging.

## CONSIDERATIONS FOR DESIGN SUCCESS

- **Functional** Serves a purpose
- **Aesthetic** Enjoyable to use
- **Innovative** Different and new, possibly using innovative technology
- **Easy to use** Understandable and with useful features
- **Simple** Unobtrusive, subtle
- **Long-lasting** Sustainable, not too fashion-sensitive
- **Environmentally friendly** Minimizes resources and pollution

